

Mentoring the Master Mason

Third Degree · prompts for the Personal Mentor

Before, during and after his Raising, and the months that follow. A beginning, not a summit, and a recognised drop-out window. Mentoring intensifies here.

1 PREPARE	■ Explain the timing, format and general structure of the evening, without giving away any ritual detail. ■ Make sure he knows he will answer the questions in open Lodge, and offer help in practising them. ■ Practical reassurance: the ceremony is solemn by design; he will be guided at every step, and everyone in the room has been where he is.
2 GUIDE	■ Re-introduce him to the Tyler, the Inner Guard and the Junior Deacon. ■ Explain how to sign in when visiting, and the care needed in Lodges under other Constitutions. ■ Cover the etiquette of responding to the Visitors' Toast, and of thanking hosts promptly. ■ Explain that Lodges work differently: observe before judging, and never criticise another Lodge's working. ■ Check he understands the structure of Grand Lodge and Provincial Grand Lodge and knows their principal Rulers. ■ Make sure he has received the Master Mason's Guide.
3 SUPPORT	■ Meet soon after the Raising. Review the evening and what it meant to him, at his pace. ■ Encourage the Lodge of Instruction and visiting across the Province; go with him the first time. ■ Introduce him to Provincial events, the Fleet House Light Blues Club and DAWG. ■ Help him find the part of Freemasonry that interests him most, and support him in exploring it. ■ Begin gentle, open conversations about whether and when he might like to take office. Both answers are valid.
4 ENLIGHTEN	■ Discuss the essence of the Third Degree and its central teaching, with humility: Brethren read it differently, and none of them wrongly. ■ Explain the Royal Arch as the completion of his journey in Pure Antient Masonry, on his timing: information, not recruitment. When he shows interest, bring in the Royal Arch Representative. ■ Encourage personal learning through Solomon: history, symbolism, the story of his own Lodge. ■ Remind him that mentoring does not end with the Third Degree, and that in time he will be a mentor to others.

Companion to the Personal Mentor's Short Guide and the Stage Checklists · Never reveal ritual · Issue 1 (Draft for Review), October 2026 · © Provincial Grand Mentor, Province of Hertfordshire, 2026